

Command Reference List

Important: Command Line Is Case-Sensitive & Space-Sensitive

Command line tools are **case sensitive** and **space sensitive**, which means you must type commands **exactly as they are written** for them to work correctly.

Useful Keyboard Shortcuts & Terminal Basics

Tab Autocompletes file and folder names to save typing and avoid mistakes.

Arrow Up / Arrow Down Scrolls through previously run commands so you can reuse or edit them.

Ctrl + C Stops a running command immediately (useful if something is taking too long or you ran the wrong command).

clear Clears the terminal screen to give you more room when things get overwhelming.

Navigation & Location

pwd (print working directory) Shows you **where you are** in the file system (your current location or “path”).

cd (change directory) Moves you from one folder to another. If you don't name a destination, cd moves you to your home directory.

cd .. Moves you one step backward along your path.

ls (list) Shows **what files and folders** are in your current location.

Viewing Files

cat (concatenate) Displays the **entire contents of a file** in the terminal.

less Lets you **scroll through a file page by page** instead of showing everything at once.

head Shows the **beginning of a file**.

head -n Shows the **first *n* lines** of a file.

Files & Folders

mkdir (make directory) Creates a **new folder**.

Mv (move) Moves or renames a file or folder.

Downloading Data

curl (client URL) Downloads data from the internet using a web address (URL).

curl -s (silent) Runs curl without showing progress messages.

curl -o (output) Saves downloaded data into a **file** instead of showing it on screen.

Working with JSON

jq Reads and extracts information from **JSON files**.

jq -r (raw output) Outputs clean text instead of quoted JSON.

Connecting Commands

| (pipe) Sends the output of one command **into another command**.

> (redirect output) Saves command output into a **new file**.

|| (logical OR) Runs the second command **only if the first one fails**.

2>/dev/null Hides error messages so they don't appear on the screen.

Text Processing

sort Arranges lines of text in **alphabetical or numerical order**.

uniq (unique) Removes duplicate lines from a list.

uniq -c (count) Counts **how many times each line appears**.

Viewing Folder Structure

tree Shows folders and files in a **branch-like tree layout**.

ls -R (recursive list) Lists everything in a folder **and all subfolders**.

Searching & Navigation Inside Files

/term Searches for text **inside less**, not in the command line itself.

q — quit Exits less and returns you to the command line.